

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM | EDR | Infrastructure Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience implementing, maintaining, and hardening robust security across enterprise infrastructure. I have deep expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) via CrowdStrike Falcon, email and web security gateway management, Privileged Access Management (PAM), and identity security using Microsoft Entra ID. I am experienced in managing vulnerability scanning and remediation programmes, overseeing penetration test findings, and delivering security awareness training to large user populations. I take technical ownership of security tooling and work closely with IT security officers and wider IT teams to maintain a strong, proactive security posture across global infrastructure. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a structured, engineering-led approach to securing complex, multi-site environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), detection engineering, alert triage, SOAR playbook development and automation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, and Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); threat hunting; incident alert response
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast email security platform (anti-phishing, email gateway policy management), web security policy management
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall management, Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS), Web Application Firewall (WAF) and Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) protection
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium endpoint management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus; vulnerability scanning, remediation tracking, penetration test finding remediation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework, end-to-end incident lifecycle, digital forensics triage, containment, eradication, and lessons learned
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, security automation, tooling integration
- **Certifications and Frameworks:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Take technical ownership of implementing, maintaining, and hardening robust security across a global enterprise infrastructure serving over 8,000 users, reporting to the senior security leadership and working within a focused security team.
- Manage and optimise enterprise email and web security gateways, including Mimecast, tuning policies to reduce phishing exposure and improving email gateway alerting coverage to protect the organisation from inbound threats.

- Oversee Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms, engineering detection rules and automated playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL) to accelerate alert triage and incident response.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), managing alert triage, threat hunting, and incident response across the end-user and server estate; coordinate Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert workflows across multiple security tooling platforms.
- Manage Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) controls via Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)) and Conditional Access policies, ensuring identity security and least-privilege access principles are enforced across the organisation.
- Administer Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) to maintain endpoint compliance and security posture across mobile and corporate device fleets.
- Lead vulnerability scanning and remediation programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), coordinating remediation workflows with infrastructure and application teams to reduce organisational risk exposure.
- Manage security certificates, oversee Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS) alerting, and administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to protect critical administrative accounts and reduce lateral movement risk.
- Remediate penetration test findings across network, application, and cloud environments, working with relevant teams to prioritise and track remediation to closure.
- Deliver security awareness training to staff and contribute to ad-hoc security projects, including policy development and supplier security assessments.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Managed SIEM and SOAR operations using Microsoft Sentinel, building and refining detection rules and alert playbooks to improve fidelity and reduce false positive rates across the security operations function.
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform, performing alert triage, threat hunting, and contributing to incident response activities across the endpoint estate.
- Configured and maintained Mimecast email security policies, tuning anti-phishing, anti-malware, and data loss prevention controls to protect the university's email communication channels.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory environments, including Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, and Group Policy, ensuring consistent identity governance and access control across the user population.
- Supported Privileged Access Management (PAM) onboarding and policy configuration via BeyondTrust, extending privileged access controls to critical systems and administrative accounts.
- Administered Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM to enforce device compliance policies and manage mobile application security across the end-user fleet.
- Operated Check Point Harmony firewall and IDS/IPS tooling, reviewing logs and rule sets to identify and respond to network-based threats.
- Conducted vulnerability scans using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing remediation reports and working with asset owners to track remediation to closure.
- Delivered security awareness training sessions and supported phishing simulation programmes, improving end-user security awareness across the institution.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Delivered security and infrastructure engineering across a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, implementing and maintaining security controls aligned to compliance and business requirements.
- Managed endpoint protection, patching cycles, and identity access controls, including MFA configuration, to maintain consistent security posture across the corporate environment.
- Conducted internal vulnerability assessments, tracked remediation activities, and assisted with penetration test preparation and finding remediation.
- Supported the deployment and configuration of email security gateway controls to protect the organisation from phishing and malware threats.

- Contributed to security policy development and collaborated with wider engineering teams to embed security controls into infrastructure and release change processes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000+ users, establishing comprehensive XDR coverage across the endpoint, identity, and cloud attack surface.
- Engineered a library of custom SIEM detection rules and SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, materially reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for priority security incidents.
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate the effectiveness of detection and response controls, delivering measurable evidence of security posture improvement to senior leadership.
- Extended BeyondTrust PAM coverage to critical administrative accounts, reducing privileged account exposure and significantly strengthening the organisation's identity security baseline against lateral movement attacks.
- Managed the rollout of Mimecast across the organisation, improving email gateway resilience against phishing, Business Email Compromise (BEC), and malware delivery campaigns.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)